

Self Custody Labs

<https://selfcustodylabs.com/>

Self Custody Labs is a free, open-source collection of Bitcoin self-custody guides, published at <https://selfcustodylabs.com/>. There is no signup, no paywall and nothing to buy. The whole site is written as step-by-step instruction rather than commentary, and the source is on GitHub.

Its premise is stated bluntly on the front page: when you do not hold the keys, you do not own the coins. Mt. Gox, Celsius and FTX are used as the worked examples — in each case, customers who held their own keys were untouched, and those who did not became unsecured creditors.

WHAT IT COVERS

- Hardware wallets — choosing one, setting it up, and signing without exposing keys
- Seed phrases — generating entropy yourself, backing up, and verifying the backup works
- Passphrases and security hardening
- Privacy — UTXO management and coin control
- Running your own node, so you verify the rules rather than trusting a server
- Multisig and air-gapped signing for larger holdings

HOW IT IS ORGANISED

Four stages, taken at whatever pace suits: **understand** what self-custody is and how private keys work; **set up** a hardware wallet and a first backup; **secure** it with a passphrase, a verified backup and your own node; then **advance** to multisig and air-gapped signing when the value you hold justifies it.

Alongside the guides there is a glossary, a hardware wallet comparison, and reading and podcast lists. The site also runs a prominent warning banner when something material breaks in the ecosystem, which makes the front page worth a periodic glance even if you have finished the guides.

Summary of an external website as at 11 September 2026. Self Custody Labs is not affiliated with this document.

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